

Greater sage-grouse

Centrocercus urophasianus



America's largest grouse lacks a muscular gizzard and cannot digest hard seeds and shoots. It relies on various kinds of sagebrush for food and cover. During the breeding season, females watch males display at a lek, a communal display ground. They select the strongest males to mate with. A few dominant males mate with the females and hens lay six to nine eggs. The chicks are fully mobile after six to eight weeks, when families may move to winter ranges at lower altitudes in search of food.

- ↔ 19–30 in (48–76 cm)
- ⚖ 3–7 lb (1.4–3.2 kg)
- ⊗ Near threatened
- 🌿 Sagebrush, insects
- 🏠 🌲



W. to C.
North America

▽ STRUT DISPLAY

When displaying at a lek, male sage-grouse rapidly inflate and deflate their breast air sacs to produce loud, far-carrying, bubbling, popping sounds. They also spread their pointed tail feathers.



Common garter snake

Thamnophis sirtalis

One of North America's most widespread reptiles, the common garter snake frequents all but very dry or very cold habitats. Across its cooler, northern range, individuals gather in burrows, caves, and similar sites to overwinter, conserving energy by slowing their metabolism. In late summer, females have litters of 10–70 babies.

- ↔ 20–49 in (51–125 cm)
- ⚖ 5–7 oz (141–198 g)
- ⊗ Common
- 🌿 Worms, fish, amphibians
- 🏠 🌲 🌿 🌊 🏠
- 📍 North America

▽ STRIPES OR SPOTS

This species typically has three light stripes running lengthwise, but some garter snakes have rows of spots.

heavily
keeled
scales



Striped scorpion

Centruroides vittatus

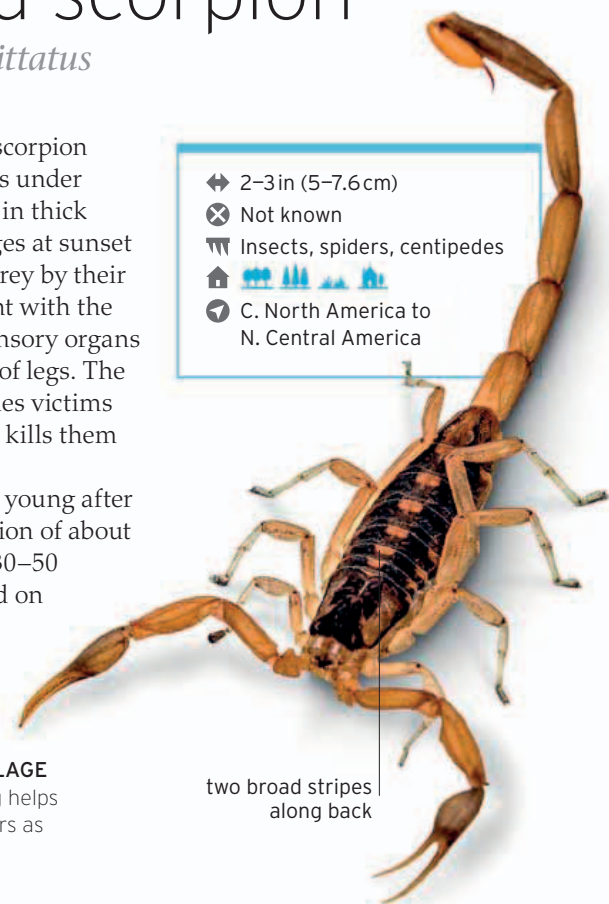
By day, the striped scorpion lurks in damp nooks under rocks and logs, and in thick vegetation. It emerges at sunset to hunt, detecting prey by their smell and movement with the help of comblike sensory organs between its last set of legs. The scorpion then crushes victims with its pincers and kills them with its stinger.

Females produce young after an estimated gestation of about eight months. The 30–50 offspring are carried on their mother's back until they molt for the first time.

- ↔ 2–3 in (5–7.6 cm)
- ⊗ Not known
- 🌿 Insects, spiders, centipedes
- 🏠 🌲 🌿 🌊 🏠
- 📍 C. North America to N. Central America

▷ PERFECT CAMOUFLAGE

The scorpion's coloring helps to hide it from predators as well as prey.



two broad stripes
along back